

SHIRA KATES

CONVERSATIONAL AI DESIGN · AGENTIC INTERFACES

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San Diego, CA

I design **context-aware, multimodal conversational experiences** where natural language and UI work together across surfaces rather than replacing each other. At Google I led design for the first generative AI product shipped from Google Cloud: natural language to fully functional app, including real-time schema editing from a single prompt. I'm focused on the hybrid visual/conversational interaction patterns and agentic workflows that make enterprise AI experiences genuinely valuable and trustworthy.

EXPERIENCE

Head of UX, AppSheet

2022 - 2026

Google, AppSheet & Cloud AI, San Diego CA

1st GenAI from Google Cloud 400% AI usage increase

2,000+ AI-built apps 1,500 Gemini tasks/day 4x MAU growth

95% satisfaction

- / **Led design of AppSheet's Gemini-powered app creation**, the first generative AI feature shipped from Google Cloud. Users describe their app in natural language; Gemini generates a fully functional schema, data model, and UI. Separately enabled real-time schema editing from a conversational prompt, collapsing what had been a multi-step technical process.
- / **Defined AI Verbs**, a system of natural language automation primitives letting users express complex logic conversationally rather than through visual programming. Drove 200% increase in usage and 2M+ AI tokens consumed across 70+ active apps.
- / **Shaped conversational design of Gemini-powered App Creation** moving from Dialogflow to LLM-powered tools; established intent taxonomy, vocabulary, response patterns, error-recovery and confirmation strategies to merge conversational and visual editing in one surface.
- / **Authored the Evolved Agents / Frontline Worker vision**, a multimodal, context-aware UX model where agents adapt their surface (voice, thin UI, rich UI) to user context. This is the hybrid conversation-plus-UI approach now influencing VP-level Cloud AI strategy and PM roadmaps.
- / **Drove 400% increase in AI feature usage** (Jul-Oct 2025) across 300+ unique apps, 1,500 Gemini AI tasks per day, 95% positive satisfaction, and 80M Vertex AI tokens in a single month.
- / Hired and embedded a **dedicated conversational design specialist** (20% role) establishing conversational design as a distinct practice within the team alongside visual design and UXR.
- / Led multidisciplinary UX team. 2025 manager ratings: Deliver Results 4.58, Develop People 4.77, Build Community 4.93 out of 5. One direct promoted to L6; team presented at Cloud NEXT and Google I/O.

UX Consultant, Assistive AI

Aug 2021 - May 2022

Course Hero · Freelance

Brought in to establish conversational AI design practice for an AI-powered homework help product. Developed UX writing guidelines and conversational AI interaction patterns; created design system components for human-AI interaction; conducted user research to

CORE EXPERTISE

CONVERSATIONAL DESIGN

Dialogue Systems Intent Architecture

Multimodal UX LLM Dialogue Design

Voice UX / VUI Error Recovery

Persona & Tone Prompt Engineering

Agentic UX Hybrid Conv + UI

AI TOOLS & PLATFORMS

Dialogflow (Google) VoiceFlow

Gemini Agent Designer Google AI Studio

Claude / Anthropic ChatGPT / OpenAI

Figma AI NotebookLM Claude CoWork

Notion AI Canva AI Vibe Coding

UX PRACTICE

UX Research UX Writing

Content Strategy Enterprise UX

0 to 1 Product Design Systems

Accessibility

LEADERSHIP

AI Vision & Roadmap

Cross-functional Alignment Design Sprints

OKR Planning Workshop Facilitation

Team Development

RECOGNITION

- Cloud Tech Impact Award, Chat Apps (2023 H2)
- Cloud Tech Impact Award, AppSheet Database (2023)
- AI Verbs debut at Cloud NEXT
- US Patent: Mobile Ad Campaign Management (2015)
- Speaker: Disruptive AI-UX Summit, SDXD, UCSD Design
- Hudson Executive Coaching Cert. (2025)

evaluate and improve how students interact with AI across surfaces. Defined nomenclature and developed rules and patterns for assistive conversational flows.

Chief Design Officer 2019 - 2022
CivicActions

Hired as Content Designer; promoted to CDO within a year. Led UX, content strategy, and design systems for government digital transformation and public sector service design. Won a \$25M federal contract as design lead.

Director, Ad Platform Programmatic Intelligence UX 2014 - 2017
Yahoo / BrightRoll

Led UX for ad platform and programmatic intelligence products through BrightRoll's \$640M acquisition by Yahoo. Built the UX practice from the ground up across data, analytics, and platform surfaces.

Senior Content Designer, Knowledge UX 2013 - 2014
Google (Maps, Search, Identity)

Content design for launched feature experiments including Explore Around You. Led the content audit of the entire Google Maps experience, improving UX for billions of users.

Content Systems Expert 2012 - 2013
Accenture Interactive

Content systems and UX strategy for enterprise clients including Meta, HP, and Microsoft.

- G2G Coach, gMentor, UCSD Design Lab judge

EDUCATION

MBA, Design Strategy
California College of the Arts

BA, English Literature
Skidmore College